

Learning Difficulty Early Screening

Questionnaire & Referral Tool

Screening for Dyslexia · Dyscalculia · General Academic Under performance

This package contains three age-specific documents:

Grade 1–3 — Early Foundation Phase (Ages 6–9)

Grade 4–6 — Intermediate Phase (Ages 10–12)

Grade 7–9 — Senior Phase (Ages 13–15)

Each document includes:

Version A — Parent / Guardian Questionnaire

Version B — Teacher Questionnaire

Version C — School Referral Checklist

⚠️ DISCLAIMER: This tool is intended for **screening purposes only** and does not provide a diagnosis. A high-risk result does not confirm a learning difficulty and a low-risk result does not rule one out. A professional evaluation by a qualified professional may be recommended.

How to Use This Tool

1. Select the document matching the student's grade band.
2. Each version should be completed independently by the relevant adult.
3. Rate each observable behaviour using the 1–5 scale provided.
4. Total the scores and consult the risk level table at the end of each section.
5. If a Moderate or High Risk result is obtained, discuss findings with the school and seek professional referral.
6. Results from all three versions (A, B, C) should be considered together for a fuller picture.

Developed as part of a data-driven educational analytics project by Palesa Sethibe.

GRADE 1–3 (Ages 6–9) · Early Foundation Phase

Version A — Parent / Guardian Questionnaire

 **DISCLAIMER:** This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis.

Please answer based on what you observe at home. This version uses language suited to children in Grades 1–3 (ages 6–9).

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

SECTION 1: READING & WRITING (Dyslexia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child struggles to recognise letters of the alphabet by name or sound.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child finds it hard to sound out simple words (e.g., "cat", "dog", "sun").	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child mixes up letters that look alike, like b and d, or p and q.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child cannot rhyme simple words (e.g., cat/hat, big/pig).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child skips lines or loses their place when looking at a page of text.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child does not want to look at books or be read to.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has difficulty remembering the order of the alphabet or days of the week.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child writes letters backwards or in the wrong direction.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child cannot spell their own name or simple sight words reliably.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child gets upset or cries when asked to read or write at home.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 1 Total Score (out of 50): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 1

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–46%	10–23	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
47–74%	24–37	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
75–100%	38–50	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 2: NUMBER & MATHS (Dyscalculia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child cannot count to 20 reliably without losing track.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child does not understand which group has more or fewer objects.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child struggles to match numbers to the correct number of objects (e.g., 3 = ●●●).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child cannot do simple adding or taking away even using their fingers.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child gets confused about the order of numbers (e.g., what comes after 7).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child finds it hard to sort objects by size, colour, or shape.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child does not enjoy or avoids number games and activities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has difficulty following a simple two-step instruction (e.g., first do this, then do that).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 2 Total Score (out of 40): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 2

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–45%	8–18	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
46–72%	19–29	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	30–40	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 3: GENERAL ACADEMIC CONCERNS

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child seems much further behind than other children their age at school.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child says they are "bad at school" or "not smart" and does not want to try.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The teacher has told me my child is struggling or needs extra help.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child needs a lot of help with very basic homework that other children manage alone.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child tries hard but still struggles — it does not seem to be about laziness or attitude.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 3 Total Score (out of 25): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 3

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–44%	5–11	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
45–72%	12–18	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	19–25	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

Additional Observations (optional):

GRADE 1–3 · Version B — Teacher Questionnaire

Grade 1–3 (Ages 6–9) — Early Foundation Phase

 **DISCLAIMER:** This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis.

Please complete based on your direct classroom observations. Rate each behaviour independently.

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

SECTION 1: READING & LITERACY (Dyslexia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student cannot reliably identify letters of the alphabet by name or sound.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student is unable to blend simple consonant-vowel-consonant (CVC) words.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student reverses or rotates letters in reading and writing (b/d, p/q, m/w).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student cannot identify or produce rhyming words when prompted.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student loses their place on the page frequently during shared reading.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student avoids or refuses participation in reading activities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has not acquired basic sight word recognition expected for their grade.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student's pencil grip and letter formation are significantly delayed for their age.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student shows emotional distress (crying, withdrawal) during literacy activities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student cannot recall phonics rules taught in class even after repeated exposure.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 1 Total Score (out of 50): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 1

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–46%	10–23	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
47–74%	24–37	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
75–100%	38–50	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 2: NUMERACY & MATHS (Dyscalculia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student cannot reliably count objects in a set up to 20.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student does not demonstrate understanding of more/fewer or bigger/smaller.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student cannot match a numeral to the correct quantity of objects.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student struggles with basic addition and subtraction within 10, even with manipulatives.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student cannot identify what number comes before or after a given number.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student cannot sort or classify objects by simple attributes (colour, shape, size).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student shows avoidance or distress during number activities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student cannot follow a two-step instructional sequence reliably.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 2 Total Score (out of 40): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 2

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–45%	8–18	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
46–72%	19–29	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	30–40	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 3: GENERAL ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student's progress is markedly behind grade-level expectations across subjects.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student's difficulties persist despite adapted teaching strategies and additional support.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student's spoken language and understanding are noticeably stronger than their written or number work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student demonstrates low self-confidence and gives up quickly on tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Factors such as language, attendance, or home environment do not fully account for the difficulties observed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 3 Total Score (out of 25): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 3

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–44%	5–11	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
45–72%	12–18	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	19–25	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

Teacher Notes (optional):

GRADE 1–3 · Version C — School Referral Checklist

Grade 1–3 (Ages 6–9) — Early Foundation Phase

⚠️ DISCLAIMER: This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis. Complete after reviewing teacher and parent input.

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

School-Level Referral Indicators — Grade 1–3

#	Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
1	The student's early literacy skills (letter recognition, phonics) are significantly below grade level.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	The student's early numeracy skills (counting, basic operations) are significantly below grade level.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	Additional classroom support or reading groups have been provided but show limited effect.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	The class teacher has expressed concern about the student's developmental progress.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	A parent or guardian has raised concern about their child's learning at home.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	The student's spoken language appears age-appropriate, but written and number work lags behind.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	Difficulties are observed consistently across literacy and numeracy — not limited to one subject.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8	The student has shown signs of distress, anxiety, or school avoidance related to learning tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	Absenteeism is not a primary factor in the student's underperformance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	The student has not previously been assessed for any learning or developmental difficulty.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
11	The difficulties have been present and persistent since the student began school.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12	Standard classroom teaching has not resulted in measurable progress for this student.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Total Score (out of 60): _____

Referral Decision Guide

% Score	Raw Score	Decision	Recommended Action
20–42%	12–25	No Immediate Referral	Continue monitoring. Review in one term.
43–67%	26–40	Consider Referral	Consult with parents and class teacher. Set support plan.
68–100%	41–60	Formal Referral Recommended	Refer to educational psychologist or specialist for assessment.

Referral Outcome & Signatures

☐ No Referral at this time ☐ Referral Recommended

Date of decision: _____

Completed by (Name & Role): _____

Signature: _____

Parent/Guardian informed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Date: _____

Notes:

This document is confidential and should be retained in the student's school record.

GRADE 4–6 (Ages 10–12) · Intermediate Phase

Version A — Parent / Guardian Questionnaire

 **DISCLAIMER:** This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis.

Please answer based on what you observe at home. This version is suited to children in Grades 4–6 (ages 10–12).

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

SECTION 1: READING & WRITING (Dyslexia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child reads slowly and with difficulty, even after years of schooling.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child skips words or guesses words when reading a passage aloud.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child makes spelling mistakes on words they have been taught many times.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has trouble understanding what they have just read.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child's written work does not reflect how well they can speak or explain things.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child avoids reading aloud or gets embarrassed when asked to read.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child takes much longer than expected to finish written assignments.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has difficulty organising their thoughts when writing.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child confuses similar-looking words (e.g., there/their, was/saw).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child shows frustration, avoidance, or anxiety around reading and writing tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 1 Total Score (out of 50): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 1

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–46%	10–23	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
47–74%	24–37	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
75–100%	38–50	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 2: NUMBER & MATHS (Dyscalculia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child still uses fingers or tallies for simple addition and subtraction.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has not memorised their times tables despite repeated practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child struggles to work out change or understand the value of money.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child gets confused about the order of steps when solving a maths problem.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child mixes up maths symbols (e.g., + and x, < and >).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has difficulty telling the time or estimating how long things will take.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child struggles to apply maths to everyday situations (e.g., sharing, measuring).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child becomes very anxious or refuses to do maths homework.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 2 Total Score (out of 40): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 2

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–45%	8–18	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
46–72%	19–29	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	30–40	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 3: GENERAL ACADEMIC CONCERNS

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child's school marks are consistently lower than expected for their effort level.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child says they feel dumb or that school is "not for them."	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teachers have raised concerns about my child's progress at meetings or in reports.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child needs significantly more help with homework than other children their age.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The difficulties continue even when my child is trying hard and getting support.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 3 Total Score (out of 25): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 3

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–44%	5–11	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
45–72%	12–18	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	19–25	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

Additional Observations (optional):

GRADE 4–6 · Version B — Teacher Questionnaire

Grade 4–6 (Ages 10–12) — Intermediate Phase

 **DISCLAIMER:** This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis.

Please complete based on direct classroom observations, independently of the student's home circumstances.

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

SECTION 1: READING & LITERACY (Dyslexia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student's reading level is significantly below the grade 4–6 expected standard.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student guesses at unfamiliar words rather than decoding them phonetically.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has persistent and inconsistent spelling errors across subjects.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student struggles to comprehend age-appropriate texts after reading them.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student's written work is notably weaker than their verbal contributions in class.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student avoids or becomes visibly anxious during reading or writing tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has difficulty organising written work (structure, sequencing ideas).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student requires extended time to complete written tasks compared to peers.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student confuses homophones or visually similar words in written work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has difficulty following multi-step written instructions independently.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 1 Total Score (out of 50): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 1

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–46%	10–23	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
47–74%	24–37	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
75–100%	38–50	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 2: NUMERACY & MATHS (Dyscalculia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student continues to rely on finger-counting for basic arithmetic operations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has not achieved reliable recall of multiplication tables.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student struggles to apply mathematical operations to word problems.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student makes errors with place value or number magnitude (e.g., 300 vs 30).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student confuses mathematical symbols or misreads operation signs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has difficulty with measurement, time, or data-handling tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student struggles to sequence steps in multi-step maths problems.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student shows significant maths anxiety that interferes with performance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 2 Total Score (out of 40): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 2

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–45%	8–18	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
46–72%	19–29	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	30–40	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 3: GENERAL ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student's academic performance is consistently below grade 4–6 expectations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Targeted classroom interventions have not produced sustained improvement.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student demonstrates a clear gap between oral ability and academic output.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student shows low motivation and avoidance behaviour specifically around academic tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Socioeconomic, language, or attendance factors do not adequately explain the observed difficulties.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 3 Total Score (out of 25): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 3

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–44%	5–11	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
45–72%	12–18	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	19–25	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

Teacher Notes (optional):

GRADE 4–6 · Version C — School Referral Checklist

Grade 4–6 (Ages 10–12) — Intermediate Phase

⚠️ DISCLAIMER: This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis. Complete after reviewing teacher and parent input.

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

School-Level Referral Indicators — Grade 4–6

#	Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
1	The student's academic records show sustained underperformance across multiple terms in the intermediate phase.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	Differentiated classroom support has been provided but has not closed the performance gap.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	One or more subject teachers have raised concern about the student's learning progress.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	A parent or guardian has raised concern about academic difficulties at home.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	The student has been placed on a support or monitoring programme within the school.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	There is a notable discrepancy between the student's verbal ability and their written academic performance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	Difficulties span multiple subjects (not limited to one area such as maths or literacy alone).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8	The student has shown increasing signs of academic-related anxiety, low self-esteem, or avoidance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	Irregular attendance is not the primary explanation for the student's underperformance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	No formal assessment for a learning disability has been conducted to date.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
11	Difficulties have persisted across more than one academic year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12	Despite available resources and support, no meaningful academic improvement has been observed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Total Score (out of 60): _____

Referral Decision Guide

% Score	Raw Score	Decision	Recommended Action
20–42%	12–25	No Immediate Referral	Continue monitoring. Review in one term.
43–67%	26–40	Consider Referral	Consult with parents and class teacher. Set support plan.
68–100%	41–60	Formal Referral Recommended	Refer to educational psychologist or specialist for assessment.

Referral Outcome & Signatures

☐ No Referral at this time ☐ Referral Recommended

Date of decision: _____

Completed by (Name & Role): _____

Signature: _____

Parent/Guardian informed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Date: _____

Notes:

This document is confidential and should be retained in the student's school record.

GRADE 7–9 (Ages 13–15) · Senior Phase

Version A — Parent / Guardian Questionnaire

 **DISCLAIMER:** This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis.

Please answer based on what you observe at home. This version is suited to adolescents in Grades 7–9 (ages 13–15).

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

SECTION 1: READING & WRITING (Dyslexia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child reads very slowly and struggles with longer or unfamiliar words.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child's written assignments are significantly shorter or weaker than expected for their age.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child continues to make spelling errors that should have been resolved by this stage.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child finds it hard to summarise or analyse what they have read.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child can explain things clearly in conversation but cannot express the same ideas in writing.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child avoids reading for leisure and becomes reluctant or anxious when reading is required.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child takes much longer than their peers to complete assignments requiring reading or writing.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has difficulty planning or structuring longer written pieces (essays, reports).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child struggles to take notes efficiently in class.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Literacy difficulties are beginning to affect my child's self-esteem or willingness to attend school.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 1 Total Score (out of 50): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 1

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–46%	10–23	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
47–74%	24–37	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
75–100%	38–50	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 2: NUMBER & MATHS (Dyscalculia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child still struggles with basic mental arithmetic at an age when it should be automatic.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has persistent difficulty with fractions, percentages, or ratios.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child struggles to manage money, budgets, or calculations in everyday life.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child gets confused about the order of steps when solving multi-step problems.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child struggles to interpret graphs, tables, or data in maths or science.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has difficulty with spatial reasoning tasks (geometry, reading maps, diagrams).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child's maths anxiety has grown over the years rather than improving.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child avoids subject choices or extra-curricular activities that involve numbers or logic.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 2 Total Score (out of 40): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 2

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–45%	8–18	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
46–72%	19–29	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	30–40	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 3: GENERAL ACADEMIC CONCERNS

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
My child's academic marks are consistently below expectations despite genuine effort.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has expressed that they feel incapable, different from peers, or hopeless about school.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Multiple teachers have raised concerns about my child's academic progress across subjects.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child requires substantially more time and assistance with schoolwork than peers their age.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The difficulties persist in spite of effort, tutoring, or additional support — they are not due to attitude or laziness.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 3 Total Score (out of 25): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 3

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–44%	5–11	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
45–72%	12–18	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	19–25	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

Additional Observations (optional):

GRADE 7–9 · Version B — Teacher Questionnaire

Grade 7–9 (Ages 13–15) — Senior Phase

 **DISCLAIMER:** This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis.

Please complete based on direct classroom and subject observations. Cross-reference with other subject teachers where possible.

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

SECTION 1: READING & LITERACY (Dyslexia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student's reading fluency and accuracy remain significantly below grade 7–9 expectations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has persistent difficulty comprehending and analysing extended texts.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student's written work (essays, reports) is notably below the standard expected for their grade.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student continues to make phonological or orthographic errors not typical for their age.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
There is a clear mismatch between the student's verbal intelligence and written output.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student struggles to take effective notes or copy accurately from the board.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student requires significantly extended time to complete reading and writing assessments.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has difficulty with higher-order written tasks (argument, analysis, synthesis).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Literacy difficulties appear to be affecting the student's performance across all subjects.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student shows avoidance, withdrawal, or distress in contexts requiring reading or writing.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 1 Total Score (out of 50): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 1

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–46%	10–23	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
47–74%	24–37	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
75–100%	38–50	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 2: NUMERACY & MATHS (Dyscalculia Indicators)

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student struggles with abstract mathematical concepts (algebra, functions, equations).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has persistent difficulty with fractions, decimals, and percentages.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student cannot reliably execute multi-step problem-solving strategies.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student has difficulty interpreting data in graphs, tables, or statistical formats.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student struggles with spatial and geometric reasoning tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student's maths anxiety is evident and impacts their willingness to attempt tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numeracy weaknesses are spilling over into performance in science or technology subjects.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Despite targeted maths support, the student continues to fall behind peers.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 2 Total Score (out of 40): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 2

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–45%	8–18	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
46–72%	19–29	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	30–40	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

SECTION 3: GENERAL ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE

Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
The student's performance is significantly and consistently below the expected standard for Grade 7–9.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Academic underperformance has persisted across multiple subjects and multiple terms.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The student's verbal intelligence and class contributions stand in sharp contrast to written performance.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
There are signs of increasing disengagement, low self-efficacy, or identity-level avoidance of academic tasks.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
External factors (language background, socioeconomic status, absenteeism) do not fully account for the degree of difficulty observed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Section 3 Total Score (out of 25): _____

Scoring & Risk Interpretation — Section 3

% Score	Raw Score	Risk Level	Recommended Action
20–44%	5–11	Low Risk	Continue monitoring. No immediate concern.
45–72%	12–18	Moderate Risk	Discuss with school support team. Monitor closely.
73–100%	19–25	High Risk	Refer for professional educational assessment.

Teacher Notes (optional):

GRADE 7–9 · Version C — School Referral Checklist

Grade 7–9 (Ages 13–15) — Senior Phase

⚠️ DISCLAIMER: This tool is intended for screening purposes only and does not provide a diagnosis.

Student Name

Date

Grade / Class

Age

School

Completed by

Rating Scale: 1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Always

School-Level Referral Indicators — Grade 7–9

#	Observable Behaviour	1	2	3	4	5
1	The student's academic records show consistent underperformance across multiple terms and subjects in the senior phase.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2	Targeted academic interventions and support programmes have not resulted in sustained improvement.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3	Multiple subject teachers have raised concern about this student's learning and academic progress.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4	A parent or guardian has raised concern about academic difficulties or emotional distress at home.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5	The student is receiving or has been recommended for additional academic or learning support.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6	There is a well-documented discrepancy between verbal/oral ability and written academic output.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
7	Academic difficulties span multiple subjects — not attributable to a single teaching or content factor.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
8	The school counsellor or psychologist has noted signs of academic-related emotional distress or disengagement.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
9	Attendance patterns do not adequately explain the level of underperformance observed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	No formal educational or psychological assessment for a learning disability has been completed.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
11	The pattern of difficulty has been present and documented over more than one academic year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
12	The student's performance has not improved meaningfully despite access to support and resources.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Total Score (out of 60): _____

Referral Decision Guide

% Score	Raw Score	Decision	Recommended Action
20–42%	12–25	No Immediate Referral	Continue monitoring. Review in one term.
43–67%	26–40	Consider Referral	Consult with parents and subject teachers. Set support plan.
68–100%	41–60	Formal Referral Recommended	Refer to educational psychologist or specialist for assessment.

Referral Outcome & Signatures

☐ No Referral at this time ☐ Referral Recommended

Date of decision: _____

Completed by (Name & Role): _____

Signature: _____

Parent/Guardian informed: ☐ Yes ☐ No Date:

Notes:

This document is confidential and should be retained in the student's school record.
